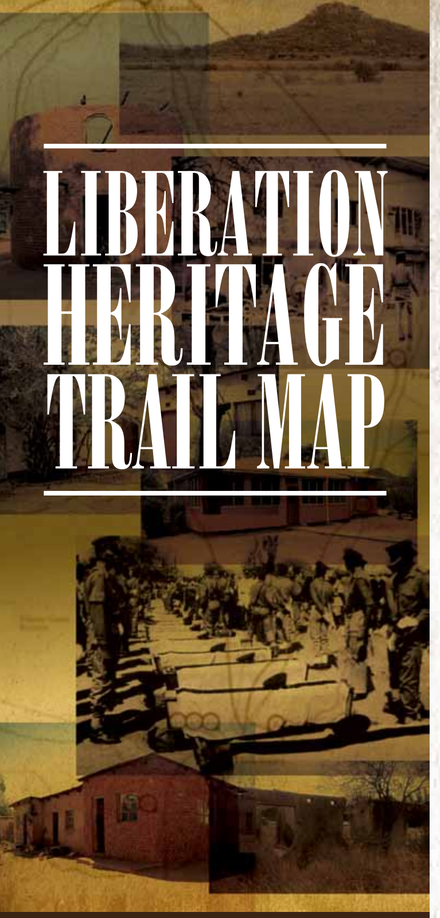
LIBERATION HERITAGE TRAIL MAP



1. Dukwi Safe Camp
2. Bontleng Refugee House
3. Samora Machel Memorial Museum
4. Sam Nujoma House
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20. Kasane Postal Tree

ANGOLA

ZAMBIA

ZIMBABWE

NAMIBIA

SOUTH AFRICA

Kasane

Kazungula

Lesoma

Baobab Prison Tree

Shakawe

Gumare

Maun

Sehitwa

Nata

Sowa

Dukwi

Ramokgwebana

Francistown

Orapa

Ghanzi

Charleshill

Central Kalahari Game Reserve

Selibe Phikwe

Northern Tuli Game Reserve

Serowe

Palapye

Mahalapye

Khutse Game Reserve

Kang

Hukuntsi

Lokgwabe

Jwaneng

Gaborone

Sikwane

Tlokweng

Otse

Lobatse

Gemsbok National Park

N

Legend

- Villages
- Liberation Heritage Route
- Railway Line
- Roads
- International Boundary
- Okavango Delta
- Makgadikgadi Pans
- Parks, Reserves

LIBERATION HERITAGE Sites

1 Dukwi Refugee Camp

Dukwi is a product of an influx of asylum seekers who flooded Botswana due to the continent's liberation wars, lasting tribal rivalries and unending civil wars. It began as an international community's relief efforts to cater for the many homeless refugees in the region. The camp was opened in 1978. This was at the time of the Zimbabwean liberation struggle when refugees were flocking from what was then known as Rhodesia. Since then, the camp has grown as crises have intensified. The Dukwi camp has in the past housed refugees from as far as Namibia, Somalia, Angola and the Democratic Republic of Congo.



Zimbabwean refugees at Dukwi Camp

2 Bontleng Refugee House

This house was occupied by the South African refugees from as early as 1977. The house is in Bontleng location - Gaborone. This house was never bombed but the occupants recieved threats from time to time by the then Apartheud regime and this made the to always be on alert.



Bontleng Refugee House

3 Samora Machel Memorial Museum

This house is an upcoming "museum". It is located in Peleng township at Lobatse. Mozambican liberation struggle leader Samora Machel and his entourage lived here on several occasions in the 1960s.





left; Samora Machel House

4 Sam Nujoma House

The Sam Nujoma house is situated in Francistown, which used to be the second centre after Lobatse with the highest concentration of refugees. In the early 1960's Sam Nujoma and other Namibian refugees are said to have stayed in this compound. The original house which was popularly called the "White House" has since been demolished.







New house standing where the original "White House" was (Plot 7440 Francistown)

5 Simon Cooper Grave

Simon Cooper, a Namibian chief of the Nama ethnic group is said to have come to Botswana as a refugee fleeing from the German wars. In Botswana he was given refugee in a place called Lokgwabe where he lived peacefully with the locals he found occupying the place until the year of his death. The people he came with have since adopted Lokgwabe as their permanent place of residence. The year 2011 saw the erection of a tombstone on his grave as an honour to this great man, initiated by his people in Namibia and the Namibian War Graves Commission.



Chief Frederick Cooper's grave with a tomb stone (Lokgwabe/Botswana)

6 Tlokweng Safe House

The Tlokweng safe house is in Tlokweng, a village which is 2 km South East of Gaborone city. The village lies a few kilometers from the Botswana - South Africa Border. The Batlokwa people are found in both Botswana and South Africa. The Batlokwa of Botswana gave refuge to the South Africans during the apartheid struggles. The Tlokweng safe house was given to the fleeing South African - mostly these were black young men from the Umkhonto We Sizwe and other liberation movements. They came through Botswana while on their way to either Europe or East Africa particularly Tanzania where they were to undergo military training.



Tlokweng Safe House

7 Lesoma National Monument

By the late 1960s, Rhodesia's government was engaged in an escalating conflict against two indigenous insurgent armies. The war drove a steady flow of refugees into north-eastern Botswana. It also motivated Rhodesian insurgents to seek safe-haven and (later) lines of communication and routes of infiltration through Botswana among a population that generally was sympathetic to their struggle. Botswana's government studiously refrained from involving itself in liberation wars, but by the mid-1970s Rhodesian security forces were making regular incursions into Botswana to kidnap or kill anti-Rhodesian dissidents. These operations did not discriminate between insurgents and local citizens; nor did the Rhodesians make significant efforts to limit collateral damage.

The Lesoma monument was established in memory of Batswana soldiers who died in the late 1970's at a place called Lesoma. The fifteen (15) soldiers met their untimely death after an army from the Ian Smith regime ambushed them. Constant attacks were launched on Botswana villages especially those along the Botswana Zimbabwe borders. Ian Smith's regime was of the feeling that Botswana was aiding the black liberation leaders and also gave ground for training of black young Zimbabweans. Rhodesia posed the most pressing security challenge in the early years. In 1965, in an effort to avert black majority rule, the white minority government of that colony had made a unilateral declaration of independence from the United Kingdom.



Lesoma Monument

8 Francistown Memorial Site

In 1985, the apartheid regime launched attacks in Botswana. Molepolole, Mogoditshane, Tlokweng and Francistown were affected in these attacks. A significant number of casualties were recorded. The greatest majority of those killed were unsuspecting artists and only a few were military people. In Francistown, a total of five people were killed. Amongst those killed was a Motswana who was a friend to the South Africans. Currently there are some remains of the house foundation on which the five people died. A monument has since been erected in honour of those who lost their lives in the house.



Monument erected in memory of the 5 people killed



Left: Remains of the bombed house (Francistown)

9 Bontleng Safe House

The Rhodesians were not the only threat on the borders. South African agents kept tabs on anti-apartheid activists in Botswana. By the late 1970s they had been responsible for a number of assassinations and kidnappings in the country. The Bontleng Safe house is one of those that were bombed during the 1985 bombings. Fortunately, all the occupants had been evacuated from the ANC office in Bontleng thus no one was killed at the time. Only the whining of a dog was heard under the rubble left by the grenades of the marauding South African Defence Force as they had launched an attack. The apartheid regime was targeting all residential houses and offices that were occupied by South African refugees who were linked to the Black Liberation Movements.



10 Ginger Safe House

The first blast occurred at Jinja location - Gaborone on the 13th February 1985. Fortunately there were no casualities. In the blast, two South African refugees miraculously escaped with minor injuries after a house they were sleeping in got bombed and completely destroyed. The two men voluntarily left Botswana immediately for their safety.



Ginger bombed house, 1985

11 Bontleng House

This is where a house was blown out by the South African apartheid regime. Fortunately the occupants had taken cover after a tip that the house was going to be bombed. The house was used by the refugees as office as well as a residential. It is located in Bontleng location - Gaborone. Where the house stood now stands a creche.



Bontleng house

12 Dimawe

This is the battlefield where Batswana people fought off Transvaal Boer invasion under the leadership of Kgosi Sechele I of Bakwena in 1852. The Boers, angered by Sechele's increased interest in buying guns and cannons, attacked the Bakwena in order to disarm them.

This war is the most significant historic event that helped shape modern day Botswana.



Dimawe

13 Extension 14 Cemetery - Gaborone

This is one site where most fallen heroes of the liberation struggles were buried in dignity. This cemetery is called the Extension 14 grave yard and it is in custody of the Gaborone City Council. The re are several induvidual graves from those who died of illness and also this is where the 1985 - 86 victims of the bombings were buried. Tese victims could not be buried in their country of birth because the then government had banned them. Most of the fallen heroes and heroines have been exhumed, repatriated and reburied in South Africa.



Extension 14 Cemetry

14 Motsamai Mpho's House

This house belongs to a veteran politician Mr. Motsamai Mpho. It was used by South African refugees in the early 1960's as they were on their way to Tanzania or Angola. Mr. Mpho gave refuge to the South Africans as he identified with them because he had been expelled by the apartheid government. The longest a refugee could stay at this house would be up to a month. Upon entering Botswana, the refugees got help from Joe Modise, Motsamai Mpho and Anderson Tshepe.



Motsamai Mpho

15 St joseph's Teacher's House

This is the house in which Mr. Onkgopotse Tiro met his untimely death. A letter bomb was sent from his native country South Africa.



St joseph's teacher's house

16 Fish Keitseng House

The House is in Peleng location - Lobatse. It is understood that Nelson Mandela, Thabo Mbeki and some other political asylum seekers from South Africa once stayed at this house. This homestead belongs to a family which was sympathetic to the South African asylum seekers and the black liberation.



Fish Keitseng House

17 Kazungula Liberation Heritage Regional Monument

The Kazungula Liberation Heritage Regional Monument and Cuito Quanavale are two (2) pronounced places within the region that symbolize and communicate the heartbeat of all liberation struggles. The Kazungula site is notable in that during the early 1960's it gave passage to all anti-colonial movements in Southern Africa on their journeys into exile where they would later constitute themselves into liberation movements.



Kazungula Ferry